वैदिक पथः(The Vēdic Path)

Abstract
This study examines Yajña (yajna) as a manifestation of divine energy within the human self, emphasizing the inseparable unity of Śakti (energy) and Jñāna (knowledge). The divine forces (Dēvatā-śaktis) inherent in Yajña are eternal, Brahman-infused imaginations that reflect the cosmic principles of Ṛta (order) and Satya (truth). Agni, the Vratapati or lord of sacred observances, awakens zeal and drives action, illuminating the subtle inner path. Every undertaking is accompanied by paired divine and demonic forces, while the cultivation of steadfast inner power (Dhruva) ensures moral and spiritual stability. Through the awakening of inner and atmospheric divine energies, the performance of yajna rites, recitation of the RigVēda, and disciplined self-study (Svādhyāya), one progresses toward the primal path and the original seat of wisdom. This framework underscores the dynamic interplay of energy, knowledge, and ritual in guiding human action and spiritual development in the Vēdic tradition.

Introduction
The Vēda primarily expounds upon *Agni* and *Yajña*. *Yajña* denotes effort or exertion, and its ultimate foundation is *Agni*, the principle of energy that sustains all endeavors. This act of sacred effort is undertaken for the attainment of the highest state, for cultivating steadfastness, for acquiring greater courage, and for generating the enthusiasm necessary to realize higher powers. Thus, the performance of *Agni*-based *Yajña* is essential.
Furthermore, this *Yajña* is a process directed toward the cultivation of noble disposition (*sadbhāva*), equality of thought (*samāna bhāvanā*), and refinement of qualities (*guṇāḥ*). It aims to harmonize the diverse tendencies within human nature toward a unified and beneficial purpose. Wherever thoughts arise, wherever knowledge conducive to proper conduct is present, and wherever the primal wisdom that gives rise to distinguishing characteristics originates toward that very source the *Yajña* directs the practitioner's striving.
With firm conviction and clarity of thought, one must ascend to that supreme state the state which the Vēda designates as *Samjñāna* (the state of complete consciousness or awareness). The method of uniting oneself with this state is termed *Yajña Karma* (the act of sacred effort). The Vēda refers to this *Yajña Karma* as *Deva Karma*, or divine action:
"Śundhadhvam daivyāya karmaṇe deva yajyāyai"
- *Taittirīya Saṁhitā* 1.1.3
This Vēdic injunction makes it evident that one must be purified in order to perform divine acts (*Deva Karma*) and the *Agni*-oriented *Yajña*. Since *Yajña* is inherently related to divinity, divine powers (*Dēvatā Śaktis*) inevitably manifest within it.
What, then, are these divine powers? They are the imaginations and creative impulses that arise continually within us - the *prajā*, or the progeny of thought itself. These imaginations are suffused with the awareness of Brahman and are eternal in nature. The energy that reveals this truth indicates that there exists no essential distinction between power (*śakti*) and knowledge (*jñāna*); they proceed together in unison. Hence, the *Brahma Vēda* refers to this inseparable union of energy and knowledge as *ṛta* (cosmic order) and *satya* (truth).

The Nature of Divine and Demoniac Energies in the Vēdic Doctrine
"**Ṛtam Satyaṃ Parambrahma Puruṣam**" - *Taittirīya Āraṇyaka* 10.12.1
This statement declares that the Supreme Brahman, as *Ṛta* (cosmic order) and *Satya* (truth), manifests as the eternal principle of the universe. The same divine energy (*Śakti*) that sustains the Brahmic consciousness also gives rise to the opposing demoniac forces (*Rākṣasa Śaktis*). The tendencies oriented toward the realization of Brahman are divine (*Dēvatā Śaktis*), while those that oppose or divert from it are demoniac. The Vēda, through its mantras, guides the aspirant toward the right direction, one must diminish the influence of demoniac tendencies within oneself.

To deny Brahman or to deviate from Brahmic awareness is to fall into ignorance. Brahman, however, is the source and foundation of all activity. It transforms into multiple powers (*Śaktis*) and governs the processes of creation, preservation, and dissolution through both divine and demoniac impulses.
For creation and preservation to become auspicious, one must follow the path of Brahman. Though there are many forms of activity (*Kāryas*), the energy that enables their execution is *Agni*. The power that performs the action is *Indra Śakti*, and the instruments required for such action are the *Indriyas* (senses). The divine energy that empowers the *Indriyas* is *Indra Dēvatā*, while the power that provides strength and nourishment to the activity is *Pūṣā Śakti*, personified as *Pūṣā Dēvatā*. This Dēvatā must be continually revered, for she grants sustenance and support to all action.
All divine powers presiding over human actions reside within the inner sanctum of one's being. These powers must be strengthened and awakened through disciplined practice. Each of these divine forces possesses its own governing energy, and among them exist deeply stable and motionless energies that underlie human behavior. These steadfast and firm powers are referred to in the Vēda as *Dhruva Śakti*, the unshakable principle. The Vēdic mantra "**Drum Hrasva**," meaning "Be firm and steadfast," occurs in the *Kṛṣṇa Yajur Vēda Saṁhitā* (1.1.3).
Agni is also called *Vrata-pati*, the Lord of the Vow. The term *Vrata* signifies the performance of action at the proper time and in accordance with sacred discipline. There exists no greater *Vrata-pati* than Agni. The very moment Agni is kindled; it generates enthusiasm within the individual and propels the work forward with renewed vigor.
Throughout life, the energy that regulates inhalation and exhalation without fail is none other than the power of Agni. Therefore, there is no vow-lord superior to Agni. For this reason, the prayer is made: "O Agni! Thou art the Vrata-pati - make me steadfast in the vow." The *RigVēda* contains numerous hymns describing the diverse manifestations of these divine powers (*Dēvatā Śaktis*), illuminating their eternal relationship with human endeavor.

The Dual Forces in Human Action: Divine and Demoniac Energies in the Vēdic Context
The Sanskrit term *Ṛk* (or *Ṛcc*) denotes the "path to action" (*kārya-sādhana-mārga*). In the language of the Vēda, it signifies the "effort toward the realization of Brahman." Hence, the *RigVēdic* hymns (*mantras*) serve as invocations to awaken and direct the divine powers (*Dēvatā Śaktis*) inherent within the human being. The *RigVēda* contains over ten thousand such hymns, each designed for the specific purpose of invoking these inner forces.
When an individual kindles within himself this inner fire of knowledge (*jñāna*) and effort (*yatna*), the subtle body (*sūkṣma-deha*) attains the ability to perceive and respond to the energies corresponding to each action undertaken. For every act that one initiates, two opposing sets of forces manifest - the *Dēvatā Śaktis* (divine powers) and the *Rākṣasa Śaktis* (demoniac powers). This dual manifestation is encapsulated in the *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* (3.3.5) statement:
"Devasurāḥ Sayatta Āsan" - "The gods and demons were ever in mutual contention."
The inner meaning of this teaching is that the aspirant must constantly strive to subdue the demoniac tendencies (*rākṣasa-bhāvas*) and establish the dominion of divine consciousness (*Dēvatā-bhāva*) within. This eternal conflict between the higher and lower forces operates incessantly within every living being. Therefore, every Vēdic yajna (*yajña*) is accompanied by mantras intended to dispel demoniac influences and fortify divine impulses.
The *Yajur Vēda* mantra **"Rakṣaḥ Pratyuṣṭaḥ"**, meaning "May the demoniac power be consumed (burned away)," illustrates this principle. This theme appears repeatedly across the *Kṛṣṇa Yajur Vēda Saṁhitā* (1.1.2) and in many other places throughout the text, including *Taittirīya Saṁhitā* (1.1.2, 1.1.4, 1.1.10), *Maitrāyaṇī Saṁhitā* (1.2, 1.4, 1.8, 1.10, 3.6, 31.1, 31.7, 31.9), *Jaiminīya Brāhmaṇa* (1.39), *Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa* (1.1, 2.2, 3.1), and *Taittirīya Brāhmaṇa* (3.2.2, 3.2.4, 3.2.1).
The detailed enumeration of these scriptural references emphasizes a profound philosophical aim: to dissolve the illusion of isolated individuality (*ahaṁ-bhāva*) and awaken the awareness of unity among all living beings. Only when this understanding arises - when one perceives the same Brahman present in all forms of life, can the aspirant ascend to the higher plane of realization (*parama-sthāna*).

The Correct Application of RigVēdic Mantras in the Process of Yajna

After the demoniac tendencies (*rākṣasa-bhāvas*) have been removed, the divine energies (*Dēvatā-śaktis*) must be invoked. It is only then that the recitation of the *RigVēdic mantras* becomes meaningful. The *RigVēda* should not be studied in isolation for mere intellectual or ritual purposes; its true value lies in its application within the *yajña*.
To utilize it correctly, one must first burn away the demoniac energies by chanting the *Yajur Vēdic* mantra "**Rakṣaḥ Pratyuṣṭaḥ**" - "May the demoniac power be consumed." Once these negative forces are dispelled, the divine energies are to be invoked and awakened.
The *RigVēda* is divided into *maṇḍalas* (sections), each containing hymns that reveal various divine energies. The *Yajur Vēda* specifies in detail how and when these *ṛks* (hymns) are to be employed in a *yajña*. Through their proper use - by awakening the divine forces, performing the yajna acts through *Agni*, and progressing step by step, the aspirant advances toward higher states of spiritual realization.
Among the many *Dēvatā-śaktis* mentioned in the *RigVēda*, certain ones are of exceptional importance. These include **Barhiḥ** (the sacred grass used in yajna), **Rathāṅgāni** (the components of the chariot), **Dundubhi** (the war drum), **Dhanuḥ** (the bow), and **Jyā** (the bowstring). Though these words appear to denote physical objects, they actually represent distinct vibrational forms - specialized sounds (*śabdas*) carrying deeper symbolic meanings related to divine forces.
The *RigVēda* clarifies that these divine energies are not celestial Dēvatās adorned with crowns and ornaments residing in heaven. Rather, they are inner principles - manifestations of cosmic energies that dwell within the human being.
From the *First Maṇḍala* to the *Tenth Maṇḍala*, the *RigVēda* unfolds a progressive revelation, beginning with the invocation of individual divine energies and culminating in the realization of the Supreme Being (*Parama Puruṣa*), the unified consciousness encompassing all forms of divinity. The seer (*ṛṣi*) Nārāyaṇa, endowed with the all-seeing mind, is said to have recited these *ṛks* as direct visions of divine truth.
The *Tenth Maṇḍala* describes the universal energies that pervade both the individual and the cosmos, revealing that the yajna process (*mantra-yajña*) symbolizes the inner transformation of the aspirant. Once the mind conceived as the altar of the *yajna* is purified by removing the *rākṣasa-bhāvas*, the recitation of the *RigVēda* must begin.
Through this process, one kindles *Agni*, the divine fire within, and, by chanting the *RigVēdic* mantras, gradually ascends toward the state of the Complete or Perfect Person (*Pūrṇa Puruṣa*).
Thus, up to this point, the essential principles underlying the *RigVēda* and *Yajur Vēda* have been clarified. The text now transitions to explain how the *Sāma Vēda*, the single, unified Vēda from which the *RigVēda*, *Yajur Vēda*, and *AtharvaVēda* later emerged, plays its role in this sacred progression.

The Distinctive Power of the Sāma Vēda and the Dynamics of Life-Energy
Although the divine presence abides within all living beings, it is often concealed in an unmanifest, incomprehensible state. From this latent condition, the essence (*tattva*) becomes perceptible through a power unique to the *Sāma Vēda*. While the other three Vēdas - *Rig*, *Yajur*, and *Atharva*, produce wonder and intellectual insight, it is the *Sāma Vēda* alone that gives rise to direct **inner experience** (*anubhūti*).
When we articulate a Vēdākshara (*akṣara*), we are not merely producing sound but engaging the vital energy (*prāṇa-śakti*). To utter even a single Vēdākshara distinctly, a specific unit of time is required, known as the *mātrā*. Within the span of one *mātrā*, if greater *prāṇa* is applied, the sound becomes louder and more forceful; if less *prāṇa* is used, it is softer. Thus, by gradually ascending through stages of controlled application of *prāṇa*, the sound becomes increasingly clear and perceptible.
This gradation of sound intensity corresponds to the three *svaras* (intonations) in Vēdic recitation - *anudātta* (low), *svarita* (middle), and *udātta* (high) upon which the musical structure of the *Vēda* is founded.
In the other three Vēdas - *RigVēda*, *Yajur Vēda*, and *AtharvaVēda*, each Vēdākshara (*akṣara*) is pronounced with one specific intonation. However, in the *Sāma Vēda*, the same *ṛk* (verse) or *yajus* (yajna formula) must be rendered through **seven distinct notes** (*svaras*). This is a fundamental principle of *Sāmic* recitation.
There are thus **seven stages** in the pronunciation of the *Sāma Vēdic akṣara*, corresponding to seven tonal gradations, each requiring the stabilization of *prāṇa-śakti* at a distinct level. These seven tonal stages are named:
Kṛṣṇa, Prathama, Dvitīya, Tṛtīya, Chaturtha, Mandra, and Atisvārya.

Of these, *Atisvārya* represents the subtlest and most delicate level, associated with the fine vibration through which *jñāna* (knowledge), *prāṇa* (vital energy), *manas* (mind), and *vāk* (speech) emerge outward from within the living being (*jīva*).
The same channel through which these forces emanate outward also serves as the inward path through which the external world enters consciousness. The senses (*indriyas*) act as intermediaries in this process - vision, hearing, and smell substitute for speech as conduits of perception. Among knowledge, vital energy, and mind, it is impossible to determine which is nearest to our essence, for all three are inseparably intertwined.
What is certain, however, is that **life arises through the triadic union** of *jñāna* (knowledge), *prāṇa* (vital force), and *manas* (mind). *Prāṇa* animates the body and propels its movement; *manas* explores and seeks out paths; *jñāna* provides discernment and direction to these movements.
Within this *jñāna* lies an immutable core - unchanging, undiminished, and ever-luminous. This fundamental knowledge governs human behavior and determines the inborn tendencies (*janma-lakṣaṇas*) of every individual. From it arises, diverse dispositions - anger, gentleness, selfishness, generosity, and various temperamental traits essential for living.
No external instruction, doctrine, or moral teaching can alter this innate *mūla-jñāna* (root knowledge). This limitation is inherent in all beings; none can remove it for another. The transformation must be achieved by the individual alone - through **self-effort**, **yajna** (*yajña*), and **the performance of acts of Agni (inner fire)**.
The *Vēdas* describe this process of transformation through mantras that reveal both the structure of creation (*sṛṣṭi-svarūpa*) and the existential condition of the living being. The purpose of *Vēdic speech* (*Vēda-vākya*) is to penetrate this innate core of knowledge and bring it into illumination. Words of external instruction, or advice received merely through hearing, cannot affect this inner realization; only the *Vēdic Word*, infused with *Agni* and *Prāṇa*, has the power to do so.

The Path of Self-Realization through Sāma Vēda
The words of great beings - *Mahāpuruṣas*, *Ṛṣis*, and *Avatāra Mūrtis* can indeed elevate one to the higher layers of knowledge. However, access to the **source-path** (*mūla-mārga*) and the **innermost foundation of knowledge** (*mūla-jñāna-sthāna*) is attainable only through **one's own effort**. This self-directed spiritual endeavor is termed **Svādhyāya** - the disciplined study and internal recitation that leads consciousness inward.
Through such practice, the energy (*śakti*) reaches the root of knowledge. No other section of the Vēda elucidates this pathway as profoundly as the *Sāma Vēda*.
While the *RigVēdic* mantra employs three tones (*svaras*) to bind the *prāṇa* (vital force) to the Vēdākshara (*akṣara*), the *Sāma Vēdic* method expands it through **seven tones**, carrying that same *prāṇa* all the way to the core of knowledge (*mūla-jñāna*). The *Sāma Vēda*, which tightly links *prāṇa* to the body, subsequently turns inward toward the **mind** (*manas*) and expounds upon its essential nature.
Ordinarily, the articulation of a Vēdākshara requires one or two *mātrās* (units of phonetic time). The *mind*, however, moves in accordance with temporal rhythm. In *Sāma-gāna* (Sāmic chanting), each Vēdākshara is extended to three, four, or even five *mātrās*, thereby preventing the mind from drifting outward. The prolonged vocalization stabilizes the mind, fixing it firmly upon the Vēdākshara, and guiding it inward.
In this manner, *Sāma-gāna* continuously directs both *mind* and *prāṇa* through the sound-form (*akṣara*) toward the **source of knowledge**. For each Vēdākshara, the *Sāma Vēda* precisely determines the level of intonation and the number of *mātrās* required for correct utterance.
Because of this extraordinary refinement, the *Sāma Vēda* is considered supremely wondrous: when the same Vēdākshara is elongated and sung through seven tonal gradations, it becomes *gāna* (melody). Thus, within the *Sāma Vēda* itself are found both *sāmas* (metrical chants) and *gānas* (musical compositions), which take numerous forms and variations.
These diverse melodic pathways reveal the inner state and spiritual position of the *jīva* (individual being). The *Vēdic* and *Śāstric* scholars have examined the depths and intricacies of such chant forms, identifying several principal modes, including:

- **Grāma-geya-gāna** (melodies of village recitation),
- **Āraṇya-gāna** (melodies of forest solitude),
- **Ūhā-gāna** (melodies formed by inference and creative variation), and

- **Ūhya-gāna** (melodies adapted to internalized or contemplative states).

These constitute the profound musical and spiritual dimensions of the *Sāma Vēda*, through which the mind and life-force ascend toward union with the root of knowledge.

Discussion

In this section we will describe some important points from the introduction and give the Method numbers and reference that will be discussed in the next sections.

Since **Yajña** (yajna) is inherently divine in nature, **divine energies (Dēvatā-śaktis)** must necessarily be present within it. What, then, are these divine energies? They are the **creative imaginations (ūhāḥ)** that arise and are continually born within us - the perpetual inner conceptions that constitute the **progeny (prajā)** of our own consciousness.

These imaginations are not mere mental constructs; they are **infused with the consciousness of Brahman** (*brahma-bhāva-pūrita*) and therefore **eternal in essence**. The energy that reveals this truth is itself indistinguishable from **knowledge (jñāna)**, for **energy and knowledge move together in unity**. Hence, this dynamic interplay of **śakti** (energy) and **jñāna** (knowledge) is what the **Vēdic Brahman** is described as - **Ṛta** (cosmic order) and **Satya** (truth).

In essence **the explanation given above** establishes that the divine energies present in every Yajña are the eternal, Brahman-filled imaginations arising within the self. These inner forces, inseparable from knowledge, embody the unity of **Śakti** and **Jñāna**, which the Vēda designates as **Ṛta** and **Satya**, the cosmic principles of order and truth [Method-1, Ref (1)].

All divine forces that govern human action dwell within the inner self. These inner powers must be strengthened, for they include both the dynamic and the steadfast energies that sustain our conduct. The Vēda calls this unwavering, stable power **Dhruva**, the immutable strength that anchors all activity within us [Method-2, Ref (2)].

Agni is the **"Vratapati"**, the lord of sacred observances. The term *vrata* denotes a duty or practice that must be performed at its proper time and carried to completion. There is no Vratapati superior to Agni. At the very moment when Agni is kindled, it awakens zeal within us and propels the execution of our undertakings, driving them forward to fruition [Method-3, Ref (3)].

The inner path and knowledge inherent within us are activated and illumined by Agni manifest in the subtle body of the living being. For every action contemplated, corresponding divine and demonic forces arise and stand before it. In other words, every undertaking is accompanied by a dual presence: the paired forces of divinity and demonic energy [Method-4, Ref (4)].

One must awaken the divine forces in the atmosphere, perform the yajna rites, and execute the functions of Agni, thereby progressing through each stage of existence toward its highest state [Method-5, Ref (5)].

This mantra is intended to elucidate the forms of all-encompassing powers present within us across the tenth mandala of the cosmos. After arriving at the resolution that the yajna ritual must commence, and once the mind conceived as the yajna altar has dispelled the obstructive demonic tendencies that impede spiritual and cognitive development, one should proceed with the recitation of the RigVēda [Method-6, Ref (6)].

Even the speech of great beings, sages, and divine incarnations can convey knowledge up to the upper layers of understanding. However, reaching the primal path and the original seat of wisdom is attainable only through one's own effort. This dedicated endeavor is termed **Svādhyāya** (self-study or self-reflective practice) [Method-7, Ref (7)].

Methods

Method-1:

RigVēda (5-51-2)

- देवता विश्वेदेवा:
- ऋषि: स्वस्त्यात्रेयः
- छन्द: निचृदनुष्टुप्
- स्वर: धैवतः

ऋतधीतय आ गत सत्यधर्माणो अध्वरम्। अग्नेः पिबत जिह्वया ॥२॥

Essence of RigVēda (5-51-2):
May prosperity and well-being arise from the materials offered in the sacred fire (*Agni*). May our charitable acts bring auspiciousness and may the yajna free from all forms of violence, be auspicious and abundant in praise and virtue.

Proposition:

- **Question:** What do the *Dēvatā Śaktis* (divine powers) in this mantra represent within the context of the *Yajña* (yajna)?
  Answer: The *Dēvatā Śaktis* symbolize the imaginative forces that arise and are constantly generated within us. These are our *Prajā*, the creative imaginations themselves which function as the divine powers within human consciousness.
- **Question:** The mantra states that the desire to "drink the Vēda" is received from all directions. What does this mean?
  Answer: It signifies that all the divine powers within us, our imaginations or *Prajā Śaktis* are collectively inspired by an intense inner aspiration to realize Vēdic truth. The "drinking of the Vēda" does not refer to an external act but to an inward process through which these divine impulses awaken consciousness and seek to absorb Vēdic knowledge. It is an inner *Yajña* motivated by the longing to know the eternal truth.
- **Question:** What does it mean that "with the flames of Agni, the truths of Dharma and the non-violent yajna are consumed"?
  Answer: The "flames of Agni" symbolize the illuminating force of consciousness. Through this energy, the principles of truth and non-violence are inwardly assimilated representing the absorption of Vēdic knowledge. The imaginations that arise within us, ignited by Agni's flame, become infused with the essence of *Brahman*, the eternal reality. These divine imaginations illuminate the inner knowledge, showing that the power of imagination (*Ūhā Śakti*) and knowledge are inseparable. Hence, this unified power of light and awareness is referred to as *Brahman*, *Vēda*, *Ṛta*, and *Satya*.

Conclusion of Method-1:
Since the *Yajña* (yajna) is fundamentally related to the *Dēvatās* (divine powers), their presence within the *Yajña* is indispensable. What, then, are these *Dēvatā Śaktis*? They are the imaginative forces that arise and are continuously generated within us. These are our *Prajā*, our own inner imaginations endowed with the nature of *Brahman* and possessing eternal continuity.
This power reveals to us that such imagination is not merely a mental function but an eternal, divine force permeated with the essence of *Brahman*. There exists no essential distinction between this power (*Śakti*) and knowledge (*Jñāna*); one invariably follows and sustains the other. Therefore, this inseparable unity of creative power and consciousness has been referred to in the Vēdic tradition as *Brahman*, *Vēda*, *Ṛta*, and *Satya*, the eternal principles of existence, knowledge, and truth.

Method-2:
Yajur Vēda (14-10)

- देवता विद्वांसः
- ऋषिः विश्वदेवः
- छन्दः निचृदष्टिः
- स्वरः मध्यमः

अनड्वान् वयः पङ्क्तिश्छन्दौ धेनुर्वयो जगती छन्दस्त्र्यविर्वयस्त्रिष्टुप् छन्दौ दित्यवाड् वयौ विराट् छन्दः पञ्चावि र्वयौ गायत्री छन्दस्त्रिवत्सो वयऽउष्णिक् छन्दस्तुर्य्यवाड् वयौऽनुष्टुप् छन्दः ॥१० ॥

Essence of Yajur Vēda (14-10):
The Vēdic meters correspond metaphorically to the ages of animals:

- **Triṣṭup** meter pauses at three places, symbolizing the age of a one-and-a-half-year-old ox.
- **Virāṭ** meter corresponds to the age of a two-year-old ox.
- **Gāyatrī** meter represents a one-and-a-half-year-old ox.
- **Uṣṇik** meter corresponds to a three-year-old ox.
- **Jagatī** meter is likened to a two-year-old cow.
- **Anuṣṭup** meter corresponds to a four-year-old ox.
- **Paṅkti** meter corresponds to the age of a two-year-old ox.

This metaphorical association highlights the Vēdic tradition's symbolic linking of poetic meter (chandas) with stages of growth in animals, reflecting the interplay of natural cycles and ritual timing.

Proposition:

- **Question:** For the strength of a one-and-a-half-year-old chick, which meter should be used in the Yajña?
  Answer: Triṣṭup meter.
- **Question:** For the strength of a two-year-old ox, which meter should be used?
  Answer: Virāṭ meter.
- **Question:** For the power of a one-and-a-half-year-old chick, which meter should be used?
  Answer: Gāyatrī meter.
- **Question:** For the power of a three-year-old chick, which meter should be used?
  Answer: Uṣṇik meter.
- **Question:** For attaining joy, which meter should be used?
  Answer: Jagatī meter.
- **Question:** For the strength of a four-year-old ox, which meter should be used?
  Answer: Anuṣṭup meter.
- **Question:** For attaining the greatest power, which meter should be used?
  Answer: Paṅkti meter.

Conclusion of Method-2:
The divine energies that govern all human actions reside entirely within the inner body. These forces must be strengthened and cultivated. Among them, there exist principal energies, as well as steadfast powers that remain stable and unmoved within us, underlying the causes of our conduct. This firm and potent energy is referred to in the Vēda as **Dhruva** (the immutable or fixed power). The present investigation substantiates this assertion through analysis supported by the **Yajur Vēda (14-10) mantra**.

Method-3:
Yajur Vēda (18-23)

- देवता कालविद्याविदात्मा
- ऋषिः देवाः
- छन्दः पङ्क्तिः
- स्वरः पञ्चमः

व्रतं च मऽऋतवश्च मे तपश्च मे संवत्सरश्च मेऽहोरात्रेऽऊर्वष्ठीवे बृहद्रथन्तरे च मे यज्ञेन कल्पन्ताम्॥२३॥

Essence of Yajur Vēda (18-23):
May the observances of my *vrata* (sacred vows) and their corresponding fruits be harmonized with the fruits of the seasons;
may the outcomes of my *tapas* (austerity) be in accord with the fruits of day and night;
may the results of my yearly undertakings correspond to the fruits of the year itself;
may the strength and support of my thighs and knees - symbols of stability and progress, be realized through the fruits of great chariots;
and may all these be rendered efficacious and complete through the power of my *yajña* (yajna act).

Proposition:

- **Question:** What does this mantra convey?
  Answer: This mantra (Yajur Vēda 18.23) reveals the *science of action in accordance with time*, the knowledge of performing deeds appropriate to their temporal order.
- **Question:** To whom is this knowledge accessible?
  Answer: This temporal science (*padhārtha vidyā*) is attained by the learned who act in harmony with the laws of time.
- **Question:** What is meant by *vrata* (vow)?
  Answer: *Vrata* means performing a prescribed action at its proper and ordained time.
- **Question:** What are the *bṛhantara rathas* (great chariots) mentioned in the mantra?
  Answer: They symbolize the mighty cosmic forces - *Agni* (Fire) and *Vāyu* (Air) - that drive universal motion.
- **Question:** What are the divisions of time indicated in this mantra?
  Answer: The divisions of time are *day and night (ahorātra)*, *seasons (ṛtu)*, and *the year (saṁvatsara)*.

Conclusion of Method-3:
Agni is the **"Vratapati"** - the lord of sacred observances. A *vrata* (sacred vow) entails performing a prescribed action at its proper appointed time and bringing it to completion. There is no Vratapati superior to Agni. The very moment Agni is kindled, it awakens zeal within us and propels the execution of our undertakings, driving them forward to fruition.

Method-4:
RigVēda (10-170-2)
- देवता सूर्यः
- ऋषि: विभ्राट् सूर्यः
- छन्द: जगती
- स्वर: निषादः

वि॒भ्राड्बृ॒हत्सुभृ॑तं वाज॒सात॑मं॒ धर्म॑न्दि॒वो ध॒रुणे॑ स॒त्यमर्पि॑तम् । अ॒मि॒त्र॒हा वृ॑त्र॒हा द॑स्यु॒हन्त॑मं॒ ज्योति॑र्जज्ञे असु॒रहा स॑पत्न॒हा ॥

Essence of RigVēda (10-170-2):
O vanquisher of enemies! O dispeller of clouds! O excellent destroyer of thieves! O possessor of luminous knowledge! O slayer of the asuras! O terminator of the wicked! O upholder of Dharma! Whose heaven and truth shine with magnificent ornaments, who is sustained by faithful attendants, and to whom abundant provisions are bountifully granted, unto such a one everything is offered.

Proposition:
- **Question:** Who is the one who vanquishes enemies, dispels clouds, destroys thieves most effectively, possesses the knowledge of the luminaries, slays the asuras, eliminates the wicked, and upholds Dharma?
  Answer: The Dēvatā of this mantra is **Sūrya**, the Sun.
- **Question:** Why do we praise Sūrya in all these ways?
  Answer: Because in every action we undertake, enemies, clouds, thieves, ignorance, asuras, and the wicked should not obstruct or hinder our progress.

Conclusion of Method-4:
The inner path and knowledge inherent within us, activated and illuminated by Agni manifest in the subtle body of the living being. For every action undertaken, corresponding divine and demonic forces arise and stand before it. In other words, every action is accompanied by the paired presence of these two energies: the divine (Dēvatā) and the demonic (rākṣasa) forces. This principle is affirmed by the statement expressed in the **RigVēda (10-170-2) mantra**.

Method-5:
RigVēda (6-75-2)

- देवता धनुः
- ऋषि: पायुर्भारद्वाजः
- छन्द: त्रिष्टुप्
- स्वर: धैवतः

धन्वना गा धन्वनाजिं जयेम धन्वना तीव्राः समदौ जयेम। धनुः शत्रोरपकामं कृणोति धन्वना सर्वाः प्रदिशो जयेम ॥२॥

Essence of RigVēda (6-75-2):
The archer, empowered by his bow, intensifies the harmful intentions of his enemy. With enthusiasm and vigor, he achieves victory. Those who wield the bow skillfully will conquer in battle. By the power of the bow, one attains success across all directions and prevails over all challenges.

Proposition:
Question: Which word is used in the Vēda to awaken the divine powers?
Answer: *Dhanuh* and *Dhanvanā*.
Question: For what purpose are the *Dhanuh* mantras used?
Answer: These mantras are employed to awaken the divine energies.
Question: What is the benefit of the *Dhanuh* mantras?
Answer: They guide every stage of the Yajña and Agni ritual toward the most auspicious course.
Question: What does the sound produced, when the bow (*Dhanus*) is strung, signify?
Answer: It intensifies the harmful intentions or fears of the enemy.
Question: What is meant by “those who perform song with the bow will conquer in battle”?
Answer: The sound of the arrow released from the bow symbolizes victory in battle.

Conclusion of Method-5:
One must awaken the divine powers in the atmosphere, perform the sacrificial rites, execute the functions of Agni, and ensure that each stage of the ritual proceeds toward its highest and most auspicious state. This principle has been examined and substantiated with the support of the RigVēda (6-75-2) mantra.

Method-6:
Yajur Vēda (39-1)
- देवता प्राणादयो लिङ्गोक्ताः
- ऋषि: दीर्घतमाः
- छन्द: पङ्क्तिः
- स्वर: पञ्चमः

स्वाहा प्राणेभ्यः साधिपतिकेभ्यः। पृथिव्यै स्वाहाऽग्नये स्वाहाऽन्तरिक्षाय स्वाहा वायवे स्वाहा। दिवे स्वाहा। सूर्याय स्वाहा ॥१॥

Essence of Yajur Vēda (39-1):
Invocations to the Dēvatās are made according to the domain of concern:
- For **prāṇas** (life-energies), the presiding Dēvatās are invoked.
- For **indriyas** (senses), the corresponding Dēvatās are invoked.
- For **pṛthivī** (Earth), the Dēvatās of the Earth are invoked.
- For **Agni** (fire), the Dēvatās associated with fire are invoked.
- For **antarikṣa** (space/sky), the Dēvatās of the atmosphere are invoked.
- For **vāyu** (air/wind), the Dēvatās governing air are invoked.
- For **dyuloka** (heavenly realm), the Dēvatās of the celestial sphere are invoked.
- For **Sūrya** (the Sun), the Dēvatās associated with the Sun are invoked.

This structured invocation reflects the Vēdic understanding that every element and function in the cosmos has its presiding divine force, which is called upon during ritual and yajna practices.

Proposition:

Question: For whom does the mantra invoke?
Answer: It invokes the Dēvatās presiding over the **prāṇas** (life-energies), **indriyas** (senses), **pṛthivī** (Earth), **Agni** (fire), **antarikṣa** (space/atmosphere), **vāyu** (air/wind), **dyuloka** (heavenly realm), and **Sūrya** (the Sun).
Question: Why are these various Dēvatās invoked?
Answer: To remove obstructive demonic tendencies that hinder the development of the self, clearing them from the mind, conceived as the yajna altar.
Question: How do these Dēvatās assist us?
Answer: They provide support and guidance through the performance of the **Yajña** (yajna ritual).

Conclusion of Method-6:
This mantra is intended to elucidate the forms of all-encompassing powers present within us across the tenth mandala of the cosmos. After arriving at the determination that the yajna ritual must commence, and once the obstructive demonic tendencies impeding spiritual and cognitive development have been removed from the mind conceived as the yajna altar, one should proceed with the recitation of the **RigVēda**. This principle is substantiated with the support of the **Yajur Vēda (39-1) mantra**.

Method-7:
RigVēda (8-19-19)

- देवता अग्निः
- ऋषि: सोभरिः काण्वः
- छन्द: ककुबुष्णिक्
- स्वर: ऋषभः

भ॒द्रो नो॑ अ॒ग्निराहु॑तो भ॒द्रा रा॒तिः सु॑भग भ॒द्रो अ॑ध्व॒रः । भ॒द्रा उ॒त प्रश॑स्तयः ॥

Essence of RigVēda (8-19-19):
May the sacred fire (*Agni*), in which the auspicious offerings are consecrated, be propitious to us and bring forth abundant prosperity. May our acts of charity yield auspicious results. May the yajna, performed without violence, be both beneficial and worthy of praise.

Proposition:

- **Question:** What is prayed for in this mantra?
  Answer: The mantra prays that the sacred fire (*Agni*), into which the auspicious offerings are made, may bring prosperity and well-being.
- **Question:** What should be the nature of our charitable acts?
  Answer: Our acts of charity should be pure and yield auspicious results.
- **Question:** What kind of yajna is considered praiseworthy according to this mantra?
  Answer: The yajna that is free from violence, beneficial in its effects, and deserving of praise is regarded as the most virtuous.
- **Question:** What brings auspiciousness to us?
  Answer: Non-violent yajnas (Ahimsā Yajña), words of praise, and the substances offered in the yajna fire (Homa) bestow auspiciousness upon us.
- **Question:** What kind of prosperity does Agni bestow?
  Answer: Agni grants us abundant wealth, prosperity, and material well-being.

Conclusion of Method-7:
If one follows the words of great beings such as sages (Ṛṣis) and incarnate manifestations (Avatāras), one may reach only the outer layers of knowledge. However, attaining the *root path* and the *source of true knowledge* is possible solely through one's own effort. This dedicated pursuit of self-realization is referred to as **Svādhyāya** (self-study). This principle is demonstrated with the support of the **RigVēda (8-19-9)** mantra.

Conclusion

The discussion demonstrates that Yajña, as an inherently divine practice, embodies the eternal interplay of Śakti (energy) and Jñāna (knowledge), manifesting as Brahman-infused imaginations within the self. These inner forces, inseparable from consciousness, reflect the cosmic principles of Ṛta (order) and Satya (truth) and guide human action toward spiritual and intellectual fulfillment. Agni, as Vratapati, catalyzes this process by awakening zeal, illuminating the inner path, and harmonizing the dual presence of divine and demonic forces in every undertaking. Strengthening steadfast inner power (Dhruva), performing yajna rites, awakening atmospheric divine energies, and engaging in disciplined self-study (Svādhyāya) collectively enable progression toward the primal path and the original seat of wisdom. Ultimately, the Vēdic framework underscores that spiritual realization and moral action are achieved through the integrated practice of ritual, knowledge, and personal effort.

References

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(2). Yajur Vēda (14-10)
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